EE-C-002147(Army-GL)
July 26, 1982

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CHILI CON CARNE, THERMOSTABILIZED, TRAY PACK

This interim Federal Specification was developed by the U.S. Army Natick Research and Development Laboratories (GL) Natick, MA 01760 based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers chili con carne thermostablized in tray pack cans.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

TT-C-495 - Coatings, Exterior, for Tinned Food Cans
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal specifications, standards, and commercial item descriptions as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions. The Index, which includes cumulative bimonthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification, and other Federal specifications, and commercial item descriptions required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from General Services Administration Business Service Centers in Boston, MA; New York, NY; Philadelphia, PA; Washington, DC; Atlanta, GA; Chicago, IL; Kansas City, MO; Fort Worth, TX; Houston, TX; Denver, CO; San Francisco, CA; Los Angeles, CA; and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal standardization documents, and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit, Preparation of Nonperishable Subsistence Items; General Specification For

FSC 8940

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Military Standards:

MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storge
MIL-STD-900	-	Bacterial Standards For Starches, Flours, Cereals, Alimentary Pastes, Dry Milks and Sugars Used in the Preparation of Canned Foods for the Armed Forces

(Copies of Military specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

Laws and Regulations:

U.S. Department of Health and Human Services

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

U.S. Department of Agriculture

U.S. Standards for Grades of Tomato Paste

U.S. Standards for Grades of Canned Tomatoes

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Information Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Director, Food Quality Assurance Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulation

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Suite 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

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National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.4, 6.1, and 6.4).

3.2 General. The tray pack product shall be free from foreign material (such as but not limited to glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, metal, etc.), foreign odor or flavor (such as but not limited to burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale, etc.) or foreign color.

3.3 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

3.3.1 Beef. The beef shall be from steers, heifers, or cows and shall be derived from any combination of carcasses, quarters, and recognizable primal and sub-primal cuts (square-cut chuck, ribs, trimmed full loins, trimmed short loins, loin ends, striploins, rounds, shoulder clods, chuck rolls, ribeyes, top rounds, knuckles, and bottom rounds). Recognizable cuts are those which, when compared to IMPS cuts, have no more than a minor amount of lean, fat, or bone removed or included from an adjacent cut. All suitable lean meat shall be used except tenderloins and any part of a rough cut may be excluded at the option of the contractor. The beef shall be in the fresh chilled state and shall be in excellent condition, i.e., exposed lean and fat surfaces shall be of a color and bloom normally associated with the class and cut of meat, and typical of meat which has been properly stored and handled; cut surfaces and naturally exposed lean surfaces shall show no more than slight darkening or discoloration due to dehydration, aging, and/or microbial activity; the fat shall show no more than a very slight discoloration due to oxidation or microbial activity; no odors foreign to fresh meat shall be present; changes in color and odor characteristically associated with vacuum-packed meat in excellent condition shall be acceptable; and there shall be no evidence of freezing, defrosting or mishandling.

3.3.1.1 Boning and trimming. The beef shall be boned and trimmed to remove objectionable material such as bone, cartilage, heavy connective tissue, etc. The boneless, trimmed meat shall meet the limitations specified in tables I and II.

3.3.1.2 Handling and storage. Handling and storage of the boned and trimmed beef prior to heat processing into the finished product shall be in accordance with the following requirements:

a. Beef heat processed on the same day as boning and trimming shall be in the temperature range of 28 to 50°F (inclusive) at all time prior to heat processing.

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b. Holding in the fresh chilled state for up to 4 days is permitted provided that the beef is maintained in the temperature range of 28 to 40°F (inclusive) at all time prior to processing.

c. Holding in the frozen state for up to 75 days is permitted provided that the beef is:

- frozen within 4 hours after acceptance.
- stored at 0°F or lower.
- protected from freezer deterioration and damage.
- stored in containers that are adequate to maintain product excellence.
- maintained without defrosting until time of processing into the finished product.

3.3.2 Tomato paste. The tomato paste shall be US grade A.

3.3.3 Wheat flour. The flour shall be general purpose, white (bleached), clean, free from mold and free from lumps that do not break under light finger pressure. In addition, flour shall comply with the bacteriological standards of MIL-STD-900.

3.3.4 Sugar. The sugar shall be clean, white refined, sucrose, liquid or granulated, cane or beet sugar or both. The sugar shall comply with the bacteriological requirements of MIL-STD-900.

3.3.5 Corn starch. The corn starch shall be white, odorless, finely pulverized, modified waxy maize food starch for use in canned foods. The starch shall be bland with essentially no cereal or starch taste and shall comply with the bacteriological requirements of MIL-STD-900.

3.3.6 Salt. The salt shall be non-iodized, clean, white, refined, sodium chloride with or without anti-caking agents.

3.3.7 Garlic powder. The garlic shall be dehydrated garlic powder that is pungent, free flowing, uniform light color, practically free from skin and scorched particles and free from husk, root base, stem, soil and mold.

3.3.8 Ground black pepper. The ground black pepper shall have a penetrating odor, a hot-bitting-pungent flavor, a light grey to speckled black-grey color, and be free from adulterants. The volatile oil content shall be not less than 2.0 percent.

3.3.9 Onion. The onions shall be chopped, dehydrated, practically free from such defects as outer skin, scorched material, outer root base, seed stems and harmless extraneous vegetable material, shall be free flowing, pungent and a bright uniform color.

3.3.10 Whole tomatoes. The whole tomatoes shall conform to US grade B or better of the US Standard for Grades of Canned Tomatoes.

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3.3.11 Bacon bits. The bacon bits shall be prepared from fresh smoked bacon. The product shall be golden brown in color and have a small piece size (approximately 1/8 inch by 1/4 inch).

3.3.12 Chili powder. The chili powder seasoning shall be of a high commercial grade.

3.3.13 Coriander. The ground coriander shall be divided from coriandrum sativium L. and shall possess a slight fragrant odor, pleasant aromatic taste with a yellowish brown or tan color. The volatile oil content shall be not less than 0.3 percent.

3.4 Beef grinding. The boned and trimmed boneless beef shall be ground through a 3/4-inch plate, using a two-bladed knife or chipped to give equivalent results.

3.5 Formulation. The formulation for the chili con carne shall be as follows:

Ingredient	Percent by weight
Beef (raw basis)	47.00
Tomato paste (32% natural tomato soluble solids)	4.75
Whole tomatoes	4.00
Bacon bits	3.00
Chili powder	2.10
Corn starch	2.05
Flour	1.75
Sugar	.75
Salt	.50
Onions, dehydrated, chopped	.50
Garlic powder	.03
Coriander, ground	.01
Black pepper	.01
Water	33.55
	100.00 percent

NOTE: If the specified tomato solids are not available, the tomato solids that are used must be calculated to bring the solid level to that specified.

3.6 Beef cooking. The ground beef shall be heated in water (approximately 3 quarts of water per 100 pounds of meat) until no raw portions are visible. The use of a continuous braising or equivalent equipment is allowed. When cooked meat is not to be frozen, the cooked meat shall be cooled as rapidly as possible and held at a temperature of 36°F or below (there shall be no evidence of freezing). If the meat is to be frozen after cooking, the temperature of the meat shall be lowered to 0°F within 24 hours after cooking and shall be held in the frozen state for not more than 14 days. The chilled or thawed meat shall be held at a temperature of 36°F or below (there shall be no evidence of freezing or refreezing for not more than 72 hours prior to removal for further processing).

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3.7 Slurry preparation. A slurry shall be made with the starch, flour and part of the water.

3.8 Chili con carne preparation. To the heated beef, add the tomato paste, whole tomatoes, bacon bits, sugar, salt, onions, and part of the water. Heat to 160°F ± 5°F. Add chili powder, garlic powder, ground coriander and black pepper. The starch and flour slurry shall be added to the beef mixture and heated to 180°F and held for approximately 5 minutes at this temperature. The volume of the final mixture shall be adjusted with water before tray filling to compensate for evaporation loss during heating.

3.9 Tray pack filling and sealing. Each tray pack (see 5.1.1) shall be filled with product such as to conform to the following requirements:

a. The average net weight shall be 106 ounces minimum.

b. No individual can shall contain less than 104 ounces of product.

c. No individual can shall contain less than 38 ounces drained weight of beef pieces.

d. The can shall be hermetically sealed with a minimum of 10 inches of vacuum immediately after filling.

3.10 Tray pack thermoprocessing. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be thermostabilized by retorting at 240°F until a sterilization value (F_o) of not less than 6.0 has been achieved, at the coldest heating point of the retort.

3.11 Fat content. The average fat content of the finished product shall not exceed 10.0 percent and no individual tray pack shall have a fat content which exceeds 12.0 percent.

3.12 Salt content. The salt content of the finished product shall not be less than 0.5 nor more than 1.25 percent.

3.13 Plant qualification. The product shall be prepared, processed, and packaged under sanitary conditions in accordance with good manufacturing practice. The product shall be processed in establishments meeting the sanitary requirements of the applicable Government inspection agency.

3.14 Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this specification. The contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and acceptance service. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of acceptance service necessary to assure compliance with the requirements of this specification. The cost of grading and acceptance services performed by the USDA involving inspection, official documentation, and related services shall be borne by the contractor.

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4.3 Plant qualification. The product shall be unacceptable if produced and stored in plants which do not meet the requirements specified in 3.13.

4.4 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected for conformance to the characteristics indicated in 4.8.2 and 4.8.3. The presence of any defect or failure to pass any test shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.5 Component and material inspection. Components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.5.1 Beef examination for condition and cut. All beef shall be examined in either the bone-in or boneless state for conformance to the condition and cut requirements in 3.3.1. Cuts initially examined in the boneless state shall be in the form of whole boneless recognizable cuts. Any nonconforming beef shall be rejected.

4.5.2 Boned and trimmed beef examination. After boning and trimming and prior to any further processing or to any freezing, the beef shall be examined for the defects listed in table II. The lot size expressed in terms of pounds shall be declared to the AMS agent by the contractor. However, the AMS agent reserves the right to declare as a lot a portion of a declared lot, if, in his or her opinion, that portion may be out of compliance with any requirements. The sample unit shall be a minimum of 12 pounds of adjacent boneless beef. If all or a portion of the sample unit falls within a larger cut, the entire cut shall be examined. Failure of the beef to meet the acceptance criteria as indicated in table I shall be cause for rejection of the lot. Except for beef rejected because of freezing, defrosting, or presence of any off-condition or because the beef has been slashed or ground, the beef may be recooked by the contractor and re-offered for examination. For re-examination, the sampling plan used shall be the one in table I designed for the next larger lot size than the one under which the lot was initially rejected. Beef shall not be re-examined more than one time.

TABLE I. Sampling plan for boned and trimmed beef

Lot size (pounds)	Sample size (No. of sample units)	Defect categories			
		Major		Minor	
		AC	RE	AC	RE
500 or less	13	1	2	3	4
501 to 1200	20	2	3	5	6
1201 to 3200	32	3	4	7	8
3201 to 10000	50	5	6	10	11
10001 to 35000	80	7	8	14	15
Reinspection lots of 10001 to 35000	125	10	11	21	22

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TABLE II. Boned and trimmed beef defects

Category		Defect 1/ 2/ 3/
Major	Minor	
151		Presence of lymph gland measuring 1.0 inch or more in any dimension.
152		Presence of blood clot measuring 1.0 inch or more in any dimension.
	201	Presence of blood clot measuring 0.5 inch or more but less than 1.0 inch in any dimension.
153		Presence of bruise measuring 1.0 inch or more in any dimension.
	202	Presence of bruise measuring 0.5 inch or more but less than 1.0 inch in any dimension.
154		Presence of bone measuring 0.3 inch or more in any dimension.
155		Presence of cartilage measuring 0.5 inch or more in any dimension.
156		Presence of backstrap or other ligament measuring 1.0 inch or more in one dimension and 0.2 inch or more in a second dimension (when measured at right angles to each other).
	203	Presence of backstrap or other ligament measuring 0.5 inch or more but less than 1.0 inch in one dimension and 0.2 inch or more in a second dimension (when measured at right angles to each other).
157		Presence of heavy connective tissue (for example, on the surface of the outside round adjacent to the knuckle, along the skin surface of the strip loin, or the gracilis membrane) measuring 2.0 square inches or more.
	204	Presence of heavy connective tissue (for example, on the surface of the outside round adjacent to the knuckle, along the skin surface of the strip loin, or the gracilis membrane) measuring 0.5 square inches or more but less than 2.0 square inches.

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TABLE II. Boned and trimmed beef defects (cont'd)

Category		Defect 1/ 2/ 3/
Major	Minor	
	205	Presence of heavy connective tissue on lower edge of short plate or flank.
	206	Presence of heavy connective (abdominal tunic) tissue on the flank measuring 1.0 inch or more in any dimension.
	207	Presence of membranous portion of diaphragm or membranous covering from skirt, flank or abdominal section of short plate measuring 3 square inches or more.
158		Presence of knuckle cover.
159		Presence of kidney, pizzle eye, pre-pubic tendon, thymus gland or hanging tender measuring 1.0 inch or more in one dimension and 0.2 inch or more in a second dimension (when measured at right angles to each other).
	208	Presence of kidney, pizzle eye, pre-pubic tendon, hanging tender or thymus gland measuring less than 1.0 inch in longest dimension.
	209	Presence of calcified (scratchy) periosteum measuring 2.0 square inches or more.
	210	Presence of shank, clod, knuckle, or bottom (outside) round with tendinous end showing less than 75 percent lean tissue on a cross-sectional cut surface.
	211	Presence of dehydrated surface measuring 1.0 square inch or more.
	212	Presence of discolored meat (including blood discolored neck meat) measuring 1.0 square inch or more.
	213	Presence of exposed major blood vessel measuring 1.0 inch or more in any dimension.
	214	Presence of cod, udder, kidney or pelvic fat.

1/ Acceptability of product with respect to the presence of foreign material (for example: glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, metal) shall be made by a US Department of Agriculture Employee. The presence of any product not in excellent condition shall cause rejection of the lot.

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2/ Evidence of freezing or defrosting, or presence of any off-condition (including but not restricted to being off-odor, slightly sticky, gassy, rancid, sour, or showing discoloration) shall cause rejection of the lot.

3/ This table contains a listing of standard defects, some of which may not apply to product which has been boned and trimmed from the specific cuts specified in 3.3.1. The listing of such defects does not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of complying with the requirements of 3.3.1.

4.6 Ingredient examination. Conformance of ingredients to identity and condition requirements shall be determined by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade certificates, invoices, certificates of analysis, or other valid documents. In addition, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically as necessary to determine conformance to the condition requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity or condition requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient lot or of any involved product.

4.7 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the ingredient preparation, product processing, can interior coating, and vacuum sealing requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation; certificates of conformance; or other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.8 Tray pack inspection. The inspection lot shall include only tray packs produced in one workshift. The USDA reserves the right to separate the inspection lot into smaller inspection lots.

4.8.1 Net weight inspection. Randomly select 30 filled and sealed tray pack cans from the inspection lot and weigh separately. Subtract the average tare weight (determined by randomly selecting and weighing 30 of the empty tray pack cans and lids used in preparing the product and dividing by 30) from the weight of each tray pack in the sample. The results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce. If the average net weight is less than 106 ounces or if the net weight of any individual can is less than 104 ounces, the lot shall be rejected.

4.8.2 Product inspection. Eight tray packs shall be selected at random from the lot. The eight tray packs shall be heated at least 15 minutes in 140 to 150°F water, opened, and inspected for the defects listed in table III.

a. If no defects are found, the lot shall be acceptable.
b. If two or more major defects are found, the lot shall be rejected.
c. If only one major defect is found, a second sample of eight tray packs shall be selected at random from the lot, heated as above, and inspected for the defects listed in table III. If any defect is found in the second sample, the lot shall be rejected.

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TABLE III. Product inspection 1/

Category	Defect
Major	
151	Drained weight of beef pieces in a can is less than 38 ounces. 2/

1/ The presence of any foreign material (e.g., glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, metal, etc.), foreign odor or flavor (e.g., burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale, etc.) or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ To determine drained weight in a can, the free liquid shall be poured off and the remaining contents shall be poured into a flat bottom container. A minimum of three times the tray pack can's volume of 190 to 212°F water shall be added to the container so as to cover the contents. The contents and water shall be agitated such as to liquify rendered fat without breaking the beef pieces. The contents shall then be poured into a U.S. Standard 1/4-inch sieve in a manner that will distribute the product over the sieve without breaking the beef pieces. Sieve area shall be such that the distributed product does not completely cover all the openings of the sieve. The sieve shall be tilted slightly and allowed to drain at least 2 minutes before determining the drained weight by subtracting the sieve tare weight from the gross weight. The drained weight shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce.

4.8.3 Fat and salt content testing. Nine tray packs shall be selected from the lot and distributed as follows:

- Three for laboratory analysis.
- Three for submission to the contractor.
- Three for retention by the inspector as a reserve sample.

The three tray packs for laboratory analysis shall be tested for fat and salt content in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, except that preparation of the sample shall be as follows. The three unopened tray packs shall be gently warmed in a water bath to melt fat adhering to the inside of the cans. The cans shall be opened and the entire contents of each can shall be separately blended in a Waring blender or equivalent. The lot shall be rejected if:

a. The average fat content of the three cans exceeds 10.0 percent.
b. The fat content in any individual can exceeds 12.0 percent.
c. The salt content in any individual can is less than 0.5 percent or more than 1.25 percent.

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Analysis of reserve samples at the request of the contractor shall not be permitted unless the original laboratory analysis indicated that the involved lot will be rejected because of non-compliance with the fat or salt content requirement. When the reserve sample is analyzed, the analysis for both fat and salt shall be made and will be considered final. Unused reserve samples shall be returned to the contractor for inclusion in subsequent lots.

4.9 Can condition examination. Examination of filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers.

4.10 Shipping container examination. When shipping containers are required to be in accordance with PPP-B-636, examination for defects in construction, closure, and reinforcement shall be in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be classified as follows: Major: National stock number, item description, contract number, or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible. Minor: (1) Other required markings missing, incorrect, or illegible; (2) Interior packing with fiberboard liner or pads not as specified; (3) When applicable, reinforcement with nonmetallic strapping or tape is not used. Level C shipping containers shall be examined only for the marking defects heretofore specified.

4.11 Unit load inspection. Inspection of unit loads shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. The product shall be packaged in accordance with level A or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. A size 1001 by 1206 by 200 tray pack can shall be filled with 106 ounces of the food product, sealed, and thermoprocessed as specified in 3.9 and 3.10. The base plate of the can shall be electrolytic chromium-coated steel and shall be of sufficient weight and temper to protect the product during shipment and storage. The entire inside area of the can shall be coated. The can shall be coated overall on the outside with a coating conforming to type I of TT-C-495.

5.1.2 Level C. The product shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1, except that cans with commercial exterior coating will be acceptable.

5.2 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with level A, B or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Four cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed, closed and reinforced in accordance with style RSC-L, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pads shall be full length and width less approximately 1/4 inch in each dimension. The box liner and pads shall be fabricated of grade V3c fiberboard.

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5.2.2 Level B packing. Four cans of product, shall be packaged as specified in 5.2.1, except that the box shall be constructed of grade V3c, V3s or V4s fiberboard.

5.2.2.1 Nonmetallic reinforcement of shipping containers. When specified (see 6.1 and 6.3), the shipping container specified in 5.2.2 shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive, filament reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to ensure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. The shipping container shall be in accordance with the Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable.

5.3 Unit loads. When specified (see 6.1), the product, packed as specified in 5.2, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified. When unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping.

5.4 Labeling. Each package shall be labeled to comply with the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder. Paper labels are not permitted. The name of the product or abbreviation thereof and date of pack (day, month, year) shall be embossed or lithographed on the end (lid) of the can. Cans shall have the following heating directions and yield:

TO HEAT

a. To heat in water: Submerge unopened tray can in boiling water. Simmer gently 35 minutes. Remove from water and open lid for serving.

b. To heat in oven: Either punch several holes in lid of tray can or open can in usual manner leaving the loose lid in place to prevent moisture loss. Place in a 350°F oven for approximately 35 to 40 minutes until contents reach an internal temperature of 165°F.

YIELD

Approximately 12 servings per tray pack.

5.5 Marking.

5.5.1 Shipping containers. In addition to any special marking required by the contract, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.5.2 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this purchase description.
(b) When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.4 and 6.4).
(c) Level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(d) When nonmetallic reinforcement is required for level B packing (see 5.2.2.1).
(e) Type and class of unit load when unit loading is required (see 5.3).

6.2 Appropriate level of pack. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling and storage of the specific item being procured, the contracting officer should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.33A/DLAR 4145.7.

6.3 Selection of nonmetallic reinforcement. The nonmetallic reinforcement specified in 5.2.2.1 should be selected for shipping containers that are destined for transfer at sea or other specific overseas operations.

6.4 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of DAR 7-104.55. The first article should be a preproduction sample consisting of 4 tray packs of product. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisition documents regarding arrangements for inspection and approval of the first article.

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8940-A392

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

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